High Confidence – News & Structural Signals

This volume focuses only on **hard signals** you can reference in calls and emails: recent acquisitions, equipment investments, and growth moves that show you're paying attention to each company's world.

1) AirBorn Inc. – Georgetown, TX (airborn.com)

CRM SNAPSHOT

Controller + CFO in your High Confidence list; `750 employees`, `$300M revenue` in your data.

ACQUISITION CLOSED Q1 2025

BIG CHANGE

In late 2024, connector giant **Molex** (a Koch subsidiary) announced an agreement to acquire AirBorn, an employee-owned company headquartered in Georgetown, TX, specializing in rugged connectors for aerospace, defense, space, medical, and industrial OEMs. The acquisition closed in early 2025 and now forms the core of Molex's new **Aerospace & Defense Division**, with combined headcount over 50,000 across 85 plants.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Moving from employee-owned to being part of Molex/Koch is a huge cultural and structural shift; they'll be under new reporting structures, integration timelines, and margin expectations.

> TALK TRACK SNIPPET
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> *"I saw Molex completed the acquisition of AirBorn and that your Georgetown operation is now at the center of their new Aerospace & Defense division. When any aerospace plant integrates into a larger portfolio, energy is one of the easiest operating costs to bring under tighter control – have you had anyone benchmark the Georgetown facility's ERCOT contracts post-deal?"*

2) AGE Industries Ltd. – Cleburne, TX (ageindustries.com)

CRM SNAPSHOT

Owner + CFO in your High Confidence list; `125 employees`, `$300M revenue` in your data.

EQUIPMENT EXPANSION 2024

HARD SIGNAL – NEW EQUIPMENT & CAPACITY EXPANSION

AGE announced the addition of **two flexo folder-gluers, two unitizers, an automated stitcher, and a new scrap-handling system** at its Texas plants. These upgrades increase efficiency, throughput per shift, and reduce forklift movements – effectively increasing production capacity within the same footprint.

SCALE CONTEXT

LinkedIn company profile notes **over 800,000 sq ft of manufacturing and warehousing** across Texas, serving five states and two countries in packaging and containers.

WHY THIS MATTERS

More machines and higher throughput mean more connected load and likely higher peak demand; the new scrap system also changes how and when motors and conveyors run.

> TALK TRACK SNIPPET
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> *"I noticed you recently invested in new flexo folder-gluers and scrap-handling systems across your Texas plants, and you're running over 800,000 sq ft of manufacturing space. When you increase throughput like that, your load shape changes – have you revisited your ERCOT contracts to match the new demand profile?"*

3) Albers Aerospace – McKinney, TX (albers.aero)

CRM SNAPSHOT

Multiple CFO contacts in your High Confidence list; `350 employees`, `$75M revenue` in your data.

ACQUISITION SPREE 2024-2025

HARD SIGNAL – ACQUISITION SPREE & EXPANDED CAPABILITIES

- **Nov 2024:** Albers announced acquisitions of **Advanced Packaging Inc.** and **Impact Case & Container**, adding specialized protective case and storage manufacturing to its portfolio and increasing manufacturing capacity.
- **Feb 2025:** Announced acquisition of **Parallel Ventures**, further strengthening aerospace manufacturing capabilities and machining depth.
- **Feb 2024:** Acquisition of **Onepath Systems LLC**, an 18-year DoD contractor for turnkey installation and technical integration, which becomes a wholly owned subsidiary under the Defense Division.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Multiple acquisitions in 12–18 months = integration work, consolidation of facilities, possible new Texas production or integration sites, and intense focus from CFO on cost control and synergy realization.

> TALK TRACK SNIPPET
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> *"You've been busy – between the Advanced Packaging, Impact Case & Container, Parallel Ventures and Onepath deals, Albers' manufacturing and integration footprint has changed a lot in the last year. In every integration I've seen, energy spend at the core plants becomes a lever for hitting synergy targets – where are you today on locking in ERCOT pricing for your McKinney operations?"*

4) Strategic Pattern You Can Point To

COMMON THEME

All three are mid-market industrials in Texas that have gone through meaningful structural change in the last 24 months – either being acquired (AirBorn), investing heavily in equipment (AGE), or acquiring others (Albers).

> HOW TO PHRASE IT
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> *"A lot of Texas industrial manufacturers like AirBorn, AGE Industries, and Albers Aerospace have been through major structural changes lately – acquisitions, new divisions, and large equipment upgrades. We've found that's exactly when it makes sense to take a fresh look at ERCOT contracts because your usage pattern and risk profile are no longer what they were when you originally signed your deals."*

SUGGESTED USAGE

Use this brief when emailing or calling **AirBorn, AGE Industries, or Albers Aerospace** – open by referencing the specific move (Molex acquisition, new flexo equipment, or recent M&A) so it's obvious you've done your homework.